

OPS-RB-001 - Seller Onboarding Runbook

Runbook | Operations

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1. Purpose

This runbook describes how Operations executes the onboarding of a new seller onto Nexora Marketplace, from signed commercial agreement through to handover to account management. It is the operational counterpart to the Seller Onboarding Policy: the policy states what must be true, this runbook states who does what and in what order.

2. Scope

Applies to every new seller account regardless of tier, category or integration method. Applies also to a material change of integration method on an existing account, for example a move from batch to real-time integration.

Does not apply to tier changes, commercial term changes or catalogue expansion on an already-onboarded account.

3. Preconditions

Onboarding must not begin until all of the following are true.

Precondition	Verified by	Evidence
Commercial agreement signed	Business	Countersigned agreement on file
KYC and entity verification complete	Operations	Verification record
Category-specific compliance verified	Operations	Category licence where applicable
Category and commission mapping agreed	Business	Mapping sheet approved
Named seller counterpart identified	Business	Name, role and contact recorded
Integration method selected	Engineering	Method recorded with rationale
Target go-live date agreed	Operations	Date with any seasonal constraint noted

If a category requires a licence, for example an FSSAI licence for grocery and fresh, that licence must be on file before catalogue preparation begins, not before go-live. Preparing a catalogue that cannot legally be published is wasted effort.

4. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Operations (System Engineer)	Owns execution, sequencing and the closure decision

Role	Responsibility
Business (Account Manager)	Owns commercial configuration and the seller relationship
Engineering	Owns integration provisioning, sandbox access and technical validation
Support	Owns readiness of the support queue and early ticket handling
IT	Owns credential issuance and access configuration

Operations owns the go or no-go decision at each stage. Business owns the commercial consequences of a delay. Where those conflict, escalate rather than compromise; see section 9.

5. Procedure

Stage 1 - Account Setup

1. Create the seller account record with seller ID, registered name, category and tier.
2. Apply the agreed commission mapping. Use sub-category mapping where margin varies materially across the range rather than a single flat rate.
3. Configure the settlement cycle and payout lag for the tier.
4. Record any category exception explicitly against the account. Do not hold category exceptions as informal knowledge.
5. Assign the account manager, support owner and operations owner.

Recording category exceptions against the account is not optional. A refund-on-report exception for perishable goods, for example, changes how refund volume should be interpreted for that account and must be findable by anyone investigating a refund anomaly later.

Stage 2 - Credential and Access Provisioning

1. Raise a credential request with IT for the selected integration method.
2. Issue **separate credentials for staging and production**. Never a shared credential across environments.
3. Configure IP allowlisting where the integration method supports it.
4. Confirm the credential is enrolled in automated rotation.
5. Record credential ownership and expiry in the credential store.

Stage 3 - Integration Enablement

1. Provision sandbox access and confirm the seller can authenticate.
2. Walk the seller counterpart through the relevant API or feed contract.
3. Agree the data quality rules that will apply and how rejections are reported.
4. For batch integrations, confirm the delivery schedule and pin all scheduled jobs to an explicit timezone.
5. For real-time integrations, confirm that the seller's consumer tolerates at-least-once delivery and deduplicates appropriately.

Stage 4 - Catalogue Preparation

1. Run a test catalogue load in sandbox.
2. Review the validation error report with the seller.
3. Correct or withhold failing records. ****Withholding a record is preferable to publishing it with poor data.****
4. Confirm tax category mapping resolves explicitly for every listing. A listing whose tax category resolves to a category default must be held for classification.

Stage 5 - Fulfilment Verification

1. Verify each fulfilment node or logistics partner.
2. Assess dispatch capacity and record the surge figure.
3. Configure label generation with a primary and a backup provider.
4. **Execute a live failover test.** Disable the primary provider and confirm that a label is generated through the backup.
5. Record any single point of failure explicitly, with the seller's acknowledgement.

Stage 6 - Pilot

1. Run a limited pilot with a bounded customer or order volume.
2. Verify order intake, dispatch, settlement and return flows end to end.
3. Record every defect found, including those fixed during the pilot.
4. Do not treat a pilot with no findings as a success. It usually means the pilot was too small or too narrow.

Stage 7 - Go-Live

1. Confirm all preconditions and stage exits.
2. Confirm Support queue readiness and brief the support owner.
3. Activate the account.
4. Monitor order flow, dispatch performance and the first settlement cycle.

Stage 8 - Stabilisation Review and Closure

1. Hold a review two weeks after go-live.
2. Assess order flow, dispatch SLA, first settlement reconciliation and ticket volume.
3. List open items with an owner and a target date for each.
4. Hand over to Business.

6. Decision Points

Decision	Criterion	Owner
Proceed to catalogue preparation	Compliance licence on file	Operations
Publish or withhold a failing catalogue record	Data quality over catalogue size	Operations

Decision	Criterion	Owner
Accept a manual interim process	Only with an explicit exit date	Operations
Accept a single point of failure	Seller acknowledgement recorded	Operations
Go or no-go at go-live	All stage exits met	Operations
Close an open item	Evidence meets the closure standard in section 7	Operations

7. Closure Standard For Open Items

An open item may be closed only on evidence that the thing works, not on evidence that it has been configured.

Item type	Acceptable closure evidence
Failover configuration	A successful live failover test
Monitoring or alerting	The alert observed firing in a controlled test
Data quality rule	Rejection report showing the rule acting
Manual process removal	The manual process confirmed retired
Seller-side change	Confirmation from the named seller counterpart

This standard exists because of a specific failure. A failover configuration item was closed in October 2025 on the evidence of a configuration entry. Eight months later the failover was needed, the stored backup credentials had expired, and no label could be generated for 2,100 perishable orders. A configuration entry is not evidence of function.

8. Exceptions

An onboarding may proceed with an exception where a precondition or stage exit is not met, provided that the exception is recorded with a rationale, an owner, a compensating control and an expiry date.

Two exception patterns recur and both require care.

Two-stage onboarding. Going live on a manual or interim process with a commitment to migrate later. Acceptable, but the exception must carry an explicit exit date. An open-ended commitment to migrate becomes permanent.

Commercial terms ahead of readiness. A seller requesting settlement terms its readiness does not support. This is a policy exception rather than an operational one and must be decided by Business under the Seller Onboarding Policy, with milestones and a compensating control such as a security deposit.

9. Escalation

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Stage exit not met and go-live date at risk	Business and Operations jointly	Within 1 working day
Compliance precondition cannot be satisfied	Operations lead, halt onboarding	Immediately
Seller requests terms outside policy	Business, as a policy exception	Within 2 working days

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Credential or access issue	IT	Same day
Integration defect found in pilot	Engineering	Same day

Where a commercial deadline conflicts with a stage exit, escalate for a documented decision. Do not resolve it by weakening the stage exit.

10. Verification

Onboarding is verified complete when all of the following hold:

1. Orders have flowed end to end for at least two weeks.
2. The first settlement cycle has reconciled against the seller's own export.
3. Dispatch SLA has been measured and recorded.
4. Every open item has an owner and a target date.
5. Every accepted exception has an expiry date.
6. The seller counterpart has confirmed handover.

11. Post-Onboarding Actions

1. Record the account configuration in the seller account overview.
2. Record all exceptions and category-specific behaviours against the account.
3. Schedule the first quarterly account review.
4. Transfer open items to the account team with dates intact.
5. Record lessons learned. Amend this runbook where a lesson is general rather than account-specific.

12. Revision History

Version	Date	Change
1.0	2023-01-10	Initial runbook
1.1	2023-04-02	Manual interim processes require an explicit exit date
2.0	2025-04-18	Restructured for category exceptions and perishable categories
2.1	2026-06-20	Separate staging and production credentials made mandatory
2.2	2026-07-24	Closure standard added; failover items require a live test